

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 5 2
 ♥ 8 7 2
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ —

♥ A K Q J 9 5

♦ J 6 3

♣ A K J 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 9 7 6 3
 ♥ 3
 ♦ K Q 10 2
 ♣ 9 7

♠ K 10 4

♥ 10 6 4

♦ A 8 7 5

♣ Q 5 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
Pass	Dbl	2 ♦	2NT
Pass	4 ♥	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass			
6 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♦ K			

North is to play 6 ♥. East leads the ♦ K. Perhaps you wouldn't have bid slam with South's cards, but he has been watching you pull off some fantastic squeeze plays and he has every confidence you will do it again.

You know East also has the ♦ Q, so your ♦ J will be a Threat card against him.

And you are 99.9% sure he also has the ♠ A, so dummy's ♠ K will also be a Threat card against him.

You should be able to squeeze him in the two suits. What is your first act?

Your first act should be to rectify the count. And the safest way to do that is to just let East hold the first trick. Who knows, he might be foolish enough to play another ♦, or even to lead the ♠ A. Defenders do make mistakes sometimes.

But not this defender, not this time.

He exits with the ♥ 3 which you take with your ♥ Q.

Pull two more rounds of trumps, then run four ♣s, ending in your hand.

You throw a ♠ from dummy and East discards ♠s and ♦s.

You are closing in. Play the ♥ J, then the ♥ 9.

Discard the ♠ 10 and ♦ 7 from dummy.

East discards the ♠ Q and ♠ 9.

East bares his ♦ Q.

At last you play the ♥ 5, and East is done, he just doesn't know it yet.

He obviously is not going to throw his ♠ A and make dummy high, so he will instead bare his ♦ Q.

So you dump dummy's ♠ K and win the last two tricks with the ♦ A and then the ♦ J.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 5
 ♥ 7 5
 ♦ A Q 10 7 2
 ♣ A J 4

♠ A 3
 ♥ K 9 8 4 2
 ♦ K 9 8
 ♣ K 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 8 7 4 2
 ♥ Q J 10
 ♦ J 3
 ♣ Q

♠ 6
 ♥ A 6 3
 ♦ 6 5 4
 ♣ 9 8 7 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass
2 ♥	Pass	4 ♠	
All Pass			
4 ♠ by East			
Lead: ♥ A			

West's 2♥ cue-bid shows ♠ support and at least a limit-raise or better. East is to play 4♠. South leads the ♥A, then a ♥ to North's ♥K. North plays a third round of ♥s.

You were expecting to see all four hands, not just West/East again. The reason you are seeing it like this is that you must do some deducing first.

You saw the bidding and you know that South started with the ♥A and North started with the ♥K.

Before you can make a good Plan you need to figure out where the ♠A, ♦K and ♣K are located.

The three unaccounted for honors have a value of 10 points and every one of them must be in North's hand. With the ♥K he still needs those points to have enough strength to open the bidding. So you can forget about either finesse working.

Now on with the plan. North/South took the first two ♥ tricks and then played a third ♥ which you won, discarding the ♦2 from dummy.

You need to pull trumps so you play your ♠K. North wins with his ♠A and returns the ♠3 to your ♠Q.**

This pulls all the trumps and also serves to rectify the count for your upcoming squeeze.

**By the way, notice that if North had played any other way he would have handed you the contract.

You plan to squeeze North in ♦s and ♣s. But if you start running your trumps now you will have a problem with dummy's discards. You will come down to the ♦A Q and the ♣A J and will have to discard one of them BEFORE North has to discard.

So dummy's ♦Q cannot be one of the Threat cards. Instead you must make the ♦J in YOUR hand a Threat.

South plays low.

You play the ♦A immediately, a Vienna Coup.

Now that you have your Threats properly positioned you can get on with the squeeze.

Overtake dummy's ♠10 and run three more ♠s.

Discard all three ♦s from dummy.

North will discard his 2 ♥s, the ♦9 and the ♣6.

And now the moment you have been waiting for all these 20 Deals.

South discards.

Play your ♠2 and discard dummy's ♣4.